

Construction Photo Essay
Building the
Back Bay
Ultralight Stitch and Glue Pram



Plans Available at:
<http://SpiralInternational.com>

Building the Back Bay Ultralight Stitch and Glue Punt

The Back Bay is a stitch and glue boat so is assembled differently than the usual Ply-on-Frame Spira International boats. The Stitch and Glue Construction Manual provides specific instructions on building this boat.



You begin by building laying out the shapes as described on the drawings directly onto the plywood you are using to build the boat. The instructions on how to do this come in the manual

Next, you cut out the pieces in to the shapes you laid out. It is generally recommended that you cut these out a little larger than is shown and then trim them once cut out to become the correct size.

You can use one panel as a pattern for the opposite one if there are two panels to be made, or on the bottom, use one cutout as a pattern to make the other side, so all of the pieces are matched.





Next, a series of holes are drilled in the edges of the plywood, and the pieces “stitched” together using either copper wire or plastic wire binding ties.



Epoxy is then mixed up with a filler. Some use a silica powder, or plastic micro-balloons to thicken the epoxy into a paste. A fillet of this compound is added on the inside of the seams:



While still wet, a tape of fiberglass is lain on top and used to support the seam. Un-thickened epoxy resin is used to wet out this tape and seal and reinforce the joint.



Once cured, the boat is then flipped over.



The stitches are cut off. If using copper wire, it is best to remove them but if using plastic tie-wraps, just snip them off and leave the inside portions, now within the inside epoxy fillet, in-place.

And epoxy having come through the seam is removed and the plywood

edges sanded in a rounded manner.

Next repeat the process on the outside, filling any seams with filled epoxy putty and cover with a fiberglass tape and unthickened epoxy to reinforce the joint.

Now, just paint the outside and inside with epoxy. You can cover with fiberglass if you wish, but it isn't required. It makes it tougher if you use fiberglass.



Flip it over and you're done:



Let's go fishing!

